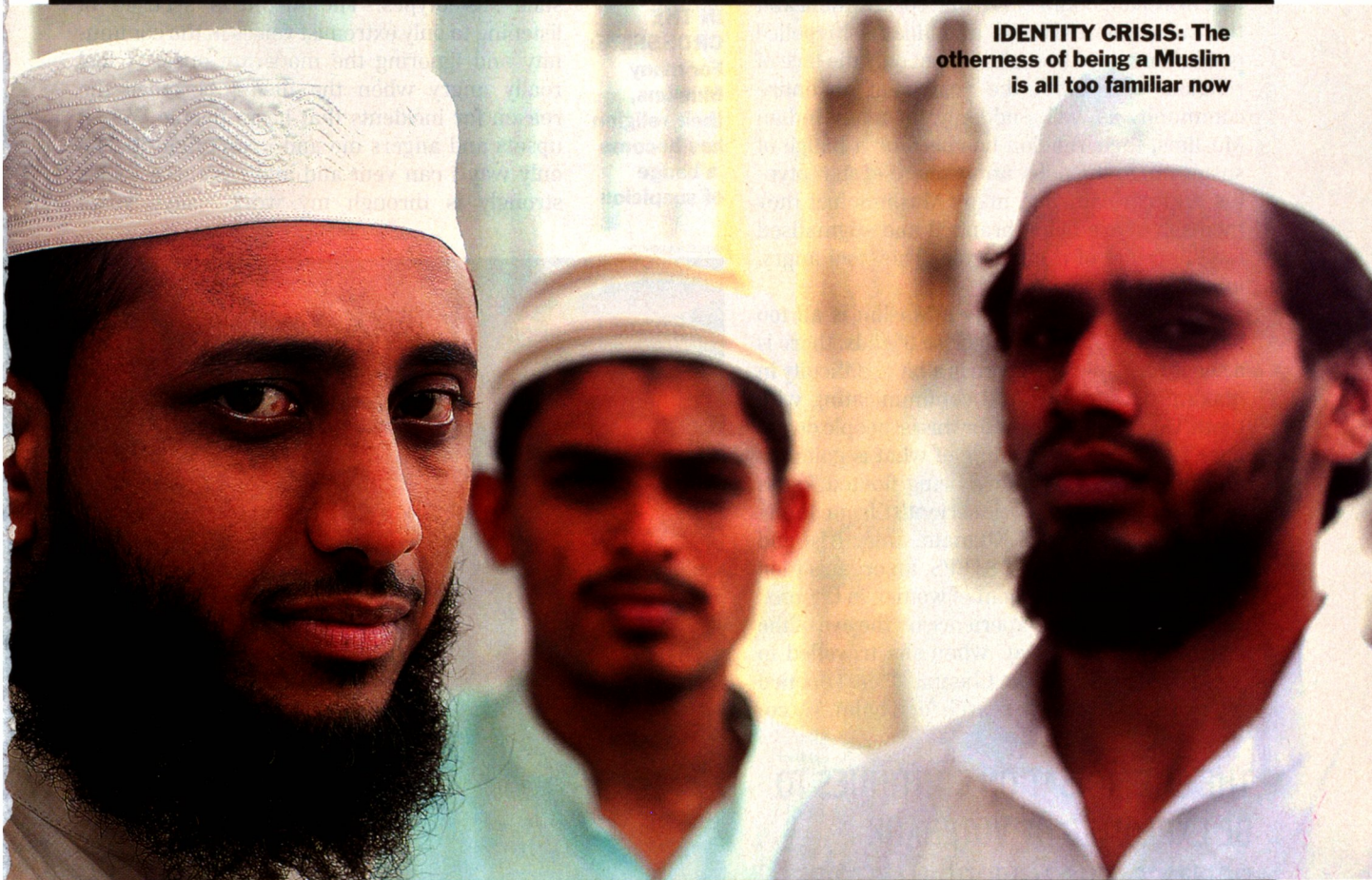


UNDER SIEGE

IDENTITY CRISIS: The otherness of being a Muslim is all too familiar now



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

In the wake of recent terror attacks by radical Islamic groups, Muslims feel victimised by stereotyping. Voices of anguish from within the community.

■ **By Shafi Rahman**

Major General Enaith Habibullah and Jawaharlal Nehru, both riding horses, stare down from a photograph on the walls of the Central Information Commission office in Delhi as Wajahat Habibullah says: "I am not your typical Muslim. I move in circles where stereotyping and Islamophobia rarely happens. At a personal level, I am not a victim. But I see a lot of stereotyping happening around nowadays in the country." The central information commissioner is modest. If there is a Muslim creamy layer, you can't get a better representative. He comes from a distinguished Lucknow family. His father, Enaith Habibullah, was the first Commandant of the National Defence Academy. Almost 10 km away, Mohammed Abid, a barber, is angry—and sad. "The Muslims are getting a bad name. Every Muslim is being made to feel like he is a part of a terrorist plot," he says as he struggles with his client's abundant black